- *Consumer*—The entity receiving messages (subscriber)
- *Message broker*—The middleware accepting messages from producers and routing them to consumers

Figure 10.3 illustrates the interaction between the actors. From the protocol point of view, we can also say that the broker is the *server*, while producers and consumers are the *clients*.

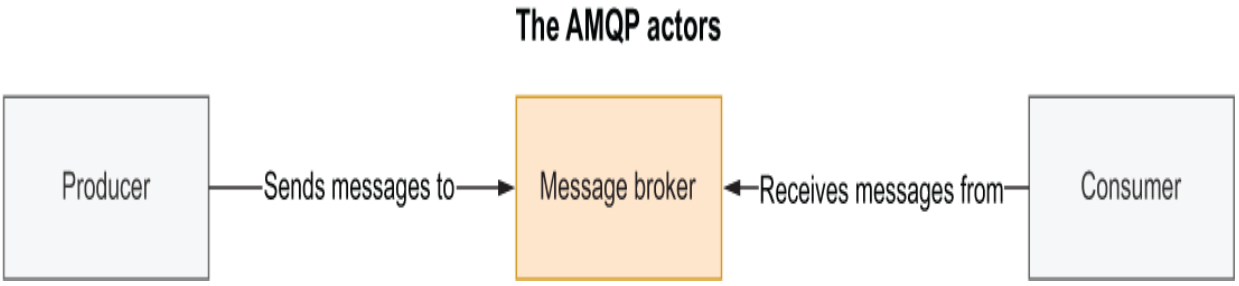


Figure 10.3 In AMQP, a broker accepts messages from producers and routes them to consumers.

NOTE RabbitMQ was initially developed to support AMQP, but it also supports other protocols, including STOMP, MQTT, and even WebSockets for delivering messages over HTTP. Since version 3.9, it also supports event streaming.

The AMQP messaging model is based on *exchanges* and *queues*, as illustrated in figure 10.4. Producers send messages to an exchange. RabbitMQ computes which queues should receive a copy of the message according to a given routing rule. Consumers read messages from a queue.